



Taiwan: the tech superpower?

Nash David

nash.david@thinkdigit.com

With the stake Taiwan enjoys in global trade, it stands out as the undisputed leader in terms of production, cost effectiveness and market delivery capabilities. This year, we visited three trade exhibitions in Taiwan hosted by Taiwan External Trade Development Council (TAITRA), the foremost non-profit trade promotion organisation in Taiwan.

TAITRA has been organising similar exhibitions to boost trade for more than three decades promoting Taiwanese companies that cut across various industrial sectors from televisions, audio/video, lighting, security to electronics components. Taiwan is the world leader in terms of global market share for chip resistors, WLAN NIC and IP phones; and number two in LED manufacturing, IC substrates and PCBs. This hints at a simple fact – you can't ignore Taiwan!

The three exhibitions co-located at the TWTC Nangang Exhibition Hall, Nangang District, Taipei, Taiwan – Taitronics, Taiwan RFID and Broadband Taiwan were aimed at the Electronics, Security, and Broadband and Internet Service industries, respectively. The Vice Presi-

dent of Taiwan, Vincent Siew, also known as the people's premier graced the event, and along with several other prominent government personnel inaugurated the event. Among the most significant announcements was that according to the IMD World Competitiveness Yearbook 2010 of the International Institute for Management Development (IMD), Lausanne, Switzerland, Taiwan ranks sixth in the world and second in Asia for its competitiveness in green technologies.

Go green

We were pleased to see green technologies being promoted by the Taiwanese



Vice President of Taiwan, Vincent Siew, briefed by Everlight's Stephan Greiner

government. We believe we need a similar boost in our country in order to witness a boost in the penetration of technologies such as LED lighting and fuel cells in organisations. According to Min-Hsien Lin, General Manager, Fuel Cell Research Division, Tatung System Technologies Inc., "Yes, compared to the millions of dollars being quoted by American and European companies for fuel cells, Taiwan's Tatung has products that meet International quality expectations at much lower costs. In fact our technologies are also safe on the environment. We also have activities dedicated to harnessing our planet."

W S Lin, Chairman and President, Tatung Co. spoke to us and told us how excited they were about the prospects in the future. As the head of a very respected and well known business house (a Tata of sorts), Lin expressed optimism towards the future. If you've not heard of Tatung before, you'd be surprised to know that you're probably using their products already. Several trusted brands (featured in our Icons of Trust) source their products from Tatung (picture tubes, LCD, LED panels and semiconductors).

The LED industry, too, is receiving the much needed fillip due to the thrust on greener technologies and is now worth over NT\$60 billion. We spoke to several